

PitchFlow — Session Summary

June 10, 2026 · ~/pitchflow · Next.js 16 + Tailwind 4 · 11 commits · 32 files changed, +4,062 / -86 · github.com/Pilot123321/pitchflow (private)

1 Stability & setup

- **Dev server removed** — `next dev` 's file watcher was freezing the Mac. The `dev` script is gone; preview via `npm run preview` (one-shot `next build && next start`, no watching).
- **Page scrolling fixed** — `overflow: hidden` on `body` blocked scroll on Submit/Explore/RFS/Detail; removed (the feed keeps its own snap container). Also fixed: detail-page CTA was unclickable beneath the floating dock.

2 Dynamic UI, grounded in HCI research

A per-frame scroll loop writes `--focus` / `--offset` CSS variables straight onto card DOM nodes (React never re-renders during scroll), driving:

- **Semantic zoom / focus+context** (Furnas '86; Perlin & Fox, Pad++ '93) — off-center cards dim to name + tagline; the focal card discloses details.
- **Staged disclosure** (Heer & Robertson '07) — chips, founder, traction, ask and CTA cascade in with staggered delays.
- **Overview+detail rail** (Cockburn et al. '09) — a dot minimap; the focal dot stretches and labels itself; click to jump.
- Parallax scene depth, pointer-tracked spotlight, spring-physics upvote with heart burst. All collapse under `prefers-reduced-motion`.

3 Hack the North re-skin

Screenshotted hackthenorth.com headlessly and extracted its computed palette/fonts, then re-themed every page, modal and the navbar:

CREAM #FDF7EA

INK #43290F

CLAY #BD580F

BRICK #AA2222

LAGOON #007899

MOSS #698019

Fredoka display type (Castledown stand-in) + Geist body · paper grain · dashed stamp chips · punched ticket stubs · scene gradients remapped from neon to lagoon/moss/clay · floating cream dock navbar with hover-pop tabs.

4 Early Merit system

Beta testers earn standing founders honor at launch (discounts, subscription exemptions):

- Tiers:  **Early Believer**  **Contributor (feedback)**  **Founding Tester (commits → locks full perk)**
- Founders set an **early perk** per pitch (ticket on the card, e.g. "50% off for life"); every signup is recorded in a `merits.json` ledger with supporter numbers; success shows a punch-card with earned stamps.

5 Founder ask types

Startups choose what they need on `/submit`:  **Early merit** ·  **Coffee chat** ·  **Co-founder** ·  **Recruiting** ·  **Marketing**. The card CTA and conversion modal copy adapt per ask; founders write their ask in their own words.

6 The reel experience (iterated with feedback)

- **Reel progress border** — a frame around the whole visible screen that fills clockwise as the video plays; profile card and like/comment/share stickers sit inside it.
- **Film-strip header edge** — replaced the scalloped edge: sprocket holes punched through the header's bottom strip advance sideways with scroll, like film through a projector (4 holes per reel).
- **Swipe-to-clear card** — the profile card follows the finger in 3D, springs back under threshold, or flies off with a perspective spin; a paper tab (or refocusing the reel) restores it.
- **3D motion layer** — card swing-in, coin-flip play button, sticker hover pops, tumbling burst hearts, modal rise. Resting layouts stay flat, symmetric, ordered.
- Layout fixes from your screenshots: play/card overlap, rail vs. card, rail vs. border, dock separation, card sizing.

7 Eight functional features (easiest → hardest)

- **Share** — native share sheet / clipboard + "Copied!"
- **Upvote persistence** — survives refresh (localStorage)
- **Coffee chat** → **Calendly** — "Book a time now" on success
- **Explore search** — filters name/tagline/founder/category
- **Real sorts** — Trending (upvotes + 3×chats + waitlist), Newest
- **Comments** — ledger + API + thread UI, live counts
- **Merit Passport** — `/profile`: all merits by email
- **Video playback** — autoplay on focal, rewind on leave, play/pause control, border synced to true playback time, lazy preload

8 Verification & open items

- Every change was verified in headless Chrome (Playwright) at mobile viewport: scripted scrolls, swipes, form round-trips, geometry checks, screenshots — gated on zero console errors.

- **Open:** a junk test pitch ("312") sits first in the feed — easy to delete from `pitches.json`. All sample videos are Big Buck Bunny (Google's sample CDN now 403s; test-videos.co.uk and Wikimedia verified as alternatives). Backend: JSON files are right for the prototype; swap to Supabase (DB + magic-link auth) before any public deploy — persistence, write-safety and merit-spoofing all hinge on it.

PitchFlow prototype · server: npm run preview → <http://localhost:3000> · repo: github.com/Pilot123321/pitchflow · summary generated with Claude Code, June 10 2026

